

Bridge the Divide

Though much has been written about the Hogenakkal project, no one has bothered to explain its technical aspect to the common man ("In Troubled Waters", April 14). I can understand a state situated upstream affecting the flow of water to a state situated downstream but not vice versa.
S. VENKATESAN, on e-mail

The tendency of politicians to fish in troubled waters is well known. One can only hope then that sanity prevails upon people on both sides and the issue is settled through dialogue and mutual understanding.
K.R. SRINIVASAN, Chennai

Lopsided Picture

The article takes a one-sided view of the IT industry ("IT Hurts", April 14). It is vital to acknowledge the contribution of the IT industry towards India's economy, which has also raised the aspirations of today's youth in a positive way. Sometimes social and emotional issues of the youth are confused as the problems of the IT industry. A number of facts referred to in the article are based on anecdotal data.

SOM MITTAL, President, NASSCOM

The author replies: The article is based on independent surveys, which point out that IT employees are under stress. I have merely quoted what the experts have deduced. The story focuses on how the lifestyle of IT professionals is taking a toll on their mental and

physical health, not how IT companies are stressing their employees out.

Misleading Facts

In the extracts from L.K. Advani's book *My Country, My Life*, he claims to have saved a madrasa in Bhavnagar during the 2002 Gujarat riots ("Testament of an Unrepentant Nationalist", March 24). This is contrary to the facts. It was the SP of Bhavnagar who saved the madrasa and its

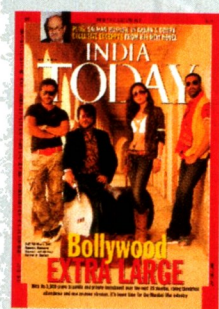
students for which he, in fact, suffered punishment.

SYED SHAHABUDDIN, Delhi

Correction

In "A Lot to Hide" (April 7), it has been erroneously mentioned that CBI Director Vijay Shankar's term was extended in 2007, when his retirement was due. Fact is that while his term was extended, his retirement was not due. He is slated to retire on July 31, 2008. The error is regretted.

POURING MOOLAH



Our youngsters are imitating Bollywood stars for all the wrong reasons—smoking, drinking and illicit relationships among many others ("Bollywood Extra Large", April 14). They simply cannot be role models for the young and do not deserve so much attention.

A. SRIKANTIAH, Bangalore

The magnitude of money pouring in on stars—be it those from Bollywood or sports—is overwhelming. However, it is ironical to see few good films earn good money and fewer sportsmen—cricket notwithstanding—earn Olympic medals.

KARAN KHARB, Noida

Today's actors are just concerned about making money due to which they no longer can be called people of substance. They can never touch the audience's hearts like yesteryear artists like Sunil Dutt or Meena Kumari. So let us take a break from the rat race for the "highest-paid" tags and begin to think beyond the self.

R.D. SINGH, Leh

Reckoned parallel to Hollywood since inception, this is the beginning of good times for the Indian film industry. With rising investment and increasing popularity, the best is yet to come.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI, Dehradun

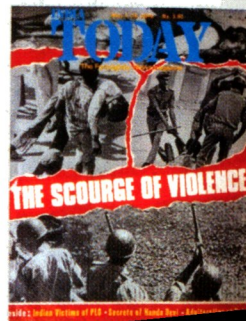
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Years Ago in India Today

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Summer of Discontent

The wave of violence that has gripped the nation since the Janata Party came into power in March last year is causing deep anxiety in the corridors of power in South Block. In the last two months, public opinion has focused on the steadily deteriorating law and order situation. The agitation in Bihar against the chief minister's decision to reserve jobs for backward



classes, Amritsar violence in Hyderabad, communal clashes in Sambhal and religious confrontations between Nihangs and Niran-karis in Amritsar have deepened public anxiety. President Sanjeeva Reddy has expressed his unease over the law and order situation. Prime minister took the floor of the Lok Sabha to plead: "Like untouchability, violence is a scourge. Let us discuss how to curb it." Almost every day in the past two months has been marred by violence in one form or another.

—Dilip Bobb

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